

CALL OF DUTY 2



3 You also blow up tanks—under heavy German fire, of course



4 You find out what's happening by reading your diary before a mission



7 The British campaign starts off in the desert, at night—beautiful setting



8 You invade 'Jerry' bunkers to find some secret documents



11 My 'mateys', seen here, help me through a series of sticky situations



12 I get to shoot German fighters out of the sky—fun, but too short-lived



15 The US tank-busters come to my rescue very often in the game



16 Some great scenery when I wandered off, but it didn't get me to the next level



19 Then it's attacking another beach—beautiful scenery again



20 I blow up a few tanks and the Allies beat the Axis to win WW II—yippie!

The Game

The game has a very realistic WW II feel to it, and looking up at the sky you'll often see fighters engaged in the classic dogfights of WW II fame. There's always smoke on the horizon and shelling in the distance. The reality extends to even gun models and the shape of vehicles and grenades. The houses and streets are authentic looking, and your gun isn't a spanking new factory-issued rifle—it has the notches and scratches that come with the rigours of regular use.

Each mission starts with an actual WW II video clip, informing you of news of the war. Then there's a view of your diary, which should tell you where you're going and why. All this combines to make an amazingly authentic setting.

The graphics are pretty good, but after having played *Quake 4*, *DOOM 3* and *Half-Life 2*, look a little amateurish. The game also has a few bugs and limitations that can be annoying—it refused to go to the next level a couple of times, even though I had completed all my tasks; people were sometimes standing or lying dead in mid-air; and the closed map design style meant you could be standing on a boundary, blocked by something you should easily be able to jump over or crawl under.

Speaking of crawling, increasing the difficulty level should see you doing a lot of that! The game is hard enough in normal mode to keep you occupied for days; any harder and you'll be playing for months!

As I said before, the AI is very good, not just for the enemy, but for your allies as well. If you're going to be playing *COD 2*, try and remember that you're a soldier in WW II, and part of a squad, so going off solo to scalp as many German kills as possible will see you stuck at one level forever. You have your orders, and you have to fulfil them before you advance!

Overall, playing this game changed my opinion about war shooters, thanks to its realistic feel, great sound and good AI—8 on 10 from this reviewer! ☒

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Publisher: Activision

Minimum System Configuration: Pentium IV 1.4 GHz or AMD Athlon 1700+, 256 MB RAM, 64 MB DirectX 9.0c compatible card

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